What's in the Planning File?

One page for where Mom's care notes are, who keeps them and when they were last looked at.

The notes from Mom's last appointment are in your bag, your brother's list is in an email, and the page you all agreed on is somewhere on the fridge.

This page doesn't ask you to read any of it again or work out what it means. It asks what there is, where it is, who keeps it, and when someone last opened it.

WHAT IT IS	WHERE IT IS	WHO KEEPS IT	LAST LOOKED AT
Notes from Mom's appointments that she has shared with the family			
What the family has written down about how her days go			
What Mom has said she wants, in her own words			
Each person's list of ideas for getting ready			
The page the family agreed on, if there is one			
The decisions the family has chosen to wait on			
Questions nobody has answered yet			
Names and phone numbers: her doctors, and the people to call in an emergency			
Offers of help: who offered, and what			
The day the family means to look at all this again			

What's missing, and who has offered to find it

Anything above with an empty box. Put a name beside it once that person has said they'll look.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody can find the page we agreed on at Easter. My brother thinks he has a photo of it and said he'd check.

Who keeps the file, and who can see it

The person who has agreed to keep it up to date, and the people Mom is happy to have read it. If either hasn't been talked about, write “not agreed yet.”

FOR EXAMPLE I've been keeping it so far, without anyone saying so. We haven't asked Mom who she wants to see it.

How to use it

- Don't copy a document onto this page or sum it up. Note where it is.
- In the last column, write the day someone last opened it, which may not be the day it was written. If nobody remembers, write “don't know.”
- This page is for care notes. Legal and financial papers aren't part of it.
- Keep the page at the front of the file, and change a line when something moves or someone else takes it over.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any note or record means, and it doesn't say what the family should do about it. If something in the file isn't clear, that's a question for the person who wrote it or said it.

Ready for the next step?

You know what's in the planning file, where each piece is and what's missing. The care interview puts the file to use: it walks you through Mom's situation as it is today, area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Keeping the names and phone numbers of Mom's doctors and emergency contacts with her care information, in one place, follows the CDC's steps for creating and maintaining a care plan. The rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Steps for Creating and Maintaining a Care Plan